3. Self-measurement of blood pressure: Electronic monitoring device allows individuals to measure their own BPs in their home with the rush of button.



4. Dial type of BP apparatus: It is lighter and useful for home visits. There is no mercury or glass. But this type may be not as accurate as the sphygmomanometer.



A stethoscope should be used with the BP apparatus in order to listen to the sounds of the brachial pulse and determine the BP reading.

5.8.2 Method of taking the Blood Pressure

1. Explain the procedure to the patient and have him seated by a table or lying with the arm supported and relaxed.
2. Place the centre of the cuff of the BP apparatus over the brachial artery and wrap it smoothly and firmly around the patient's arm 5cm just above elbow. Junk the end neatly.
3. Find the brachial pulse with the fingers and place the stethoscope over it.
4. Close the sinew valve and inflate the cuff until the pulse disappears and above that about 20 mm mercury
5. Open the valve slowly and listen for the first sound while watching the manometer reading. The first sound given the systolic reading. As air escapes, the sounds become louder and cleaner.
6. Continue to let air out slowly. As you listen the sounds suddenly become dull and at this point take the Diastolic reading.
7. Allow all the air to escape and the mercury to all to zero
8. Repeat the procedure, if there is any doubt about the reading
9. Record the reading the systolic pressure in always written over the Diastolic pressure eg. 120/80 mmHg
10. Remove the cuff from the patient's arm, roll and replace in the box.

5.9 Level of Consciousness

Loss of consciousness means that there is some interference with the normal working of the brain. The person who is unconscious is not aware of what is happening around him.



Human brain has the capacity to generate approximately 23 watts of power when awake.

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